MODI ALL THE WAY

Nine years into his prime ministership, his aura remains undiminished, come price rise or the lack of jobs. The BJP is in pole position to win a record third term in 2024

By **RAJ CHENGAPPA**

At the zenith of their Test cricket careers, Sachin Tendulkar and Rahul Dravid, both prolific run-getters for India, talked of entering 'the zone' while batting. Asked what this zone was, Tendulkar said, "I see nothing except the ball while I am batting. The concentration is such that you don't think of anything else." Dravid said something similar, adding that he did not even see the sight screen, the non-striker, the umpire or who was bowling when he was in the zone. Virender Sehwag, one of cricket's most unconventional hitters, believes that the skill lies in keeping your head still, your body in balance, for a batsman to score plenty of runs.

If there is ever a zone in politics, then in his ninth year as prime minister, Narendra Modi has entered it. How else does one explain the phenomenon where, in the midst of a major economic crisis both in terms of

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